

James Thompson

☎ +64 2102339469 • ✉ 1jamesthompson1@gmail.com
🌐 james.sjhl.nz • in [james-thompson-532246208](https://www.linkedin.com/in/james-thompson-532246208)
👤 [1jamesthompson1](https://github.com/1jamesthompson1) • 📷 [1jamesthompson1](https://www.instagram.com/1jamesthompson1)

Education

Victoria University of Wellington

Wellington, New Zealand

Master of Artificial Intelligence, A+ coursework, thesis not yet completed Feb 2025 – Nov 2026

Coursework focused on deep learning, evolutionary computation, and Natural Language Processing.

Smaller capstone projects include [Agentic LLM cheating tendencies evaluation](#), [Deep RL for continuous robotic control algorithm design](#)

Main research project is on AI alignment, specifically value alignment of LLMs to various subgroups of the New Zealand population and testing for downstream behavioural differences and alignment. Background work [here](#) and main project [report](#) and [website](#).

Massey University

Extramural, New Zealand

BSc in Computer Science, Grade: 94% / A+

2021 – 2023

Minoring in Statistics and Mathematics

Work Experience

New Zealand Transport Accident Investigation Commission

Wellington, NZ

Technical Lead (AI/Data Science)

July 2023 – Current

Led the design and development of an AI-powered document analysis platform, deployed organisation-wide in November 2024 with a complete rewrite deployed in November 2025:

- Built an LLM-powered data pipeline that ingests and processes transport accident investigation reports from TAIC (NZ), ATSB (Australia), and TSB (Canada), extracting structured datasets of safety issues, recommendations, and report sections
- Implemented a RAG architecture with vector search (LanceDB) enabling semantic search across 100,000+ document segments, this powers an Agentic LLM to create a "smart assistant".
- Developed a web application featuring a smart assistant and search tool.

Open source: [TAIC-engine](#) | [TAIC-smart-tools](#)

Self-employed

Remote, Global

Freelance Developer and Data Scientist

April 2023 – Current

I work part-time on contract and freelance IT projects. My work includes developing business administration systems, such as a pupil attendance and invoicing system for a music school, and conducting data science projects like analyzing trends in health insurance claims.

Massey University

Remote, NZ

Teaching Assistant

February 2023 – November 2023

During my final year of undergraduate studies, I worked as a teaching assistant in Computer Science and Statistics courses. My responsibilities included grading assignments and tests, as well as providing one-on-one tutoring.

Telefund NZ

Remote, NZ

Telefundraiser / Developer

April 2021 – August 2023

I started as a tele-fundraiser and later transitioned into an administrative role. I developed an automated system to streamline administrative responsibilities and assist other callers and administrators.

Skills

Programming languages: Experienced with Python, comfortable with Javascript and bash, familiar with Rust and C++.

Machine Learning frameworks: Experienced with PyTorch and JAX/Flax

AI concepts: Experienced with LLMs (training, applications and evaluations), Deep RL and Evolutionary Computation. Also worked within the AI safety and Alignment research space.

DevOps: Experienced with Docker, Azure, Git and CI/CD pipelines

Research: Experienced working with HPC (Slurm), $\text{\LaTeX}$, academic writing and literature reviews

Soft: Experience in project planning, time management and self-directed work.

Extra-Curricular

Summer Research Massey University 2022/2023.....

Project: Worked with Dr. J Godfrey on the [BrailleR](#) package to enhance accessibility for vision-impaired users working with the R statistical programming language. Focused on:

- Expanded the graph explainer to include more ggplot2 graph types.
- Working with [Diagcess](#) (JS library) to create interactive webpages for blind users to explore ggplot graphs through a keyboard and sound interface

Competitive Snowboarding.....

Experience: I have been competing in [Freeride Snowboarding](#) since age 12, traveling overseas to compete with northern hemisphere athletes.

Highlights and achievements:

- Won the 2025 Winter Games NZ North Face Frontier 4* event (held in August 2024)
- Competed at the Freeride Junior World Championship in 2020 (Austria) and 2021 (Switzerland).
- Qualified level 2 instructor with Snowboard Instruction New Zealand.

Scholarships and Awards

2026: BlueDot Impact Rapid Grant (\$1,500 USD) – Awarded for Master’s project

2025: Wellington Graduate Award, Victoria University

2023: Massey University Scholar Award

2023: Massey University Undergraduate Excellence Scholarship

2022: Massey School of Mathematical and Computational Sciences Summer Scholarship

2022: Massey University Elite Sports Bursary

2021: Massey University Academy of Sports Scholarship

2020: Upper Hutt Cosmopolitan Kickstart Career Scholarship

2020: Hutt Valley High School David Kaye Excellence Award

2019: Hutt Valley High School Best Senior Debater Award